

SAT Practice Test 10 Answer Key

Complete Answers, Explanations, and Test Taking Tricks

1. D	2. A	3. A	4. B	5. B	6. A	7. B
8. A	9. C	10. C	11. B	12. C	13. B	14. D
15. D	16. A	17. C	18. D	19. D	20. C	21. A
22. C	23. C	24. D	25. D	26. B	27. A	28. C
29. C	30. B	31. A	32. D	33. A	34. B	35. A
36. C	37. D	38. B	39. A	40. C	41. D	42. B
43. A	44. C	45. D	46. D	47. B	48. 78	49. 2
50. D	51. D	52. A	53. D	54. C	55. B	56. A
57. B	58. B	59. D	60. A	61. C	62. D	63. D
64. B	65. C	66. A	67. B	68. A	69. C	70. B
71. A	72. B	73. A	74. D	75. C	76. C	77. A
78. D	79. B	80. D	81. B	82. C	83. D	84. C
85. C	86. D	87. B	88. A	89. A	90. B	91. B
92. C	93. A	94. D	95. A	96. C	97. 118	98. 3
99. A	100. D	101. A	102. D	103. D	104. C	105. B
106. C	107. A	108. D	109. C	110. B	111. B	112. D
113. A	114. A	115. C	116. B	117. C	118. C	119. A
120. B	121. A	122. B	123. C	124. D	125. B	126. C
127. B	128. D	129. B	130. A	131. A	132. D	133. C
134. B	135. B	136. A	137. A	138. C	139. D	140. D
141. C	142. A	143. D	144. C	145. B	146. -6	147. 1

MODULE 1: READING & WRITING

Question 1 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: In context, "eschew" means deliberately avoid. The surrounding sentence requires that sense; the other choices conflict with the relationship described.

Trick: Replace the tested word with each option. Keep the choice that preserves both the sentence logic and the exact degree of meaning.

Question 2 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: In context, "unaware" means not knowing. The surrounding sentence requires that sense; the other choices conflict with the relationship described.

Trick: Replace the tested word with each option. Keep the choice that preserves both the sentence logic and the exact degree of meaning.

Question 3 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: In context, "inane" means silly and lacking sense. The surrounding sentence requires that sense; the other choices conflict with the relationship described.

Trick: Replace the tested word with each option. Keep the choice that preserves both the sentence logic and the exact degree of meaning.

Question 4 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: In context, "idiosyncratic" means distinctively unusual. The surrounding sentence requires that sense; the other choices conflict with the relationship described.

Trick: Replace the tested word with each option. Keep the choice that preserves both the sentence logic and the exact degree of meaning.

Question 5 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Main Idea | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The passage centers on the evidence that the named feature is associated with the outcome and may have been underestimated, while carefully avoiding a stronger causal claim than the study supports.

Trick: Choose the answer that covers the whole passage and matches its level of certainty. Reject choices with words such as "only," "proves," or claims that reverse the relationship.

Question 6 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Main Purpose | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The passage first identifies a limitation, then explains how a newer approach addresses that limitation without making an absolute rejection of the older method.

Trick: Track what each sentence is doing. A purpose answer must describe the passage as a whole, not just one detail.

Question 7 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Overall Structure | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The correct choice follows the sequence of moves in the passage: accepted view, complicating evidence, mechanism, and a qualified conclusion.

Trick: For structure questions, summarize each sentence in a few words before comparing the answer choices.

Question 8 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Detail (According to the Text) | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The passage explicitly states that the difference between the groups was smallest on the final observation. The other choices alter the sample counts, experimental design, or direction of the result.

Trick: For detail questions, locate the exact sentence that answers the question. Do not infer beyond what the passage directly says.

Question 9 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Inference / Complete the Text | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The follow-up pattern strengthens the possibility of a relationship because changes in the two variables move together over time. However, untested background factors remain possible, so the evidence does not justify an absolute causal claim.

Trick: Look for the answer that uses all parts of the evidence. Hard inference questions often reward a conclusion that is stronger than mere correlation but weaker than proof.

Question 10 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Evidence - Data / Graph / Table | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The correct choice accurately describes the table and matches the claim. In the harder version, a small local reversal does not erase the overall positive tendency because the model does not require perfect monotonicity.

Trick: Read the claim before the numbers. Then choose the option that is both numerically accurate and logically relevant to that exact claim.

Question 11 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Evidence - Support / Weaken | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: An intervention that changes the proposed cause while holding other conditions similar provides the strongest direct support for the hypothesized causal relationship.

Trick: For support or weaken questions, ask what evidence changes the causal logic, not merely what mentions the same topic.

Question 12 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Cross-Text | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Text 2 does not simply reject Text 1. It accepts part of the relationship while limiting the conditions under which the indicator can be relied on.

Trick: Cross-text questions often hinge on degree. Distinguish disagreement from qualification and partial agreement.

Question 13 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Function (Underlined Portion) | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The underlined sentence provides the logical bridge between the observed pattern and the methodological or causal conclusion that follows.

Trick: Ask why the author needed that exact sentence. Focus on its role in the argument, not merely its topic.

Question 14 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Quotation Illustrates Claim | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The correct quotation directly expresses every part of the stated characterization. The distractors either support only part of the claim, contradict it, or merely describe the setting.

Trick: Match every part of the claim. A quotation that supports only half of a two-part or qualified characterization is not enough.

Question 15 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The subject is "density," which is singular. The phrase "along with the thickness" does not change the number of the subject, so "determines" is correct.

Trick: Ignore interrupting phrases between the subject and verb. Match the verb to the true grammatical subject.

Question 16 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Both sides of the blank are independent clauses. A semicolon correctly joins two closely related independent clauses.

Trick: Test the text on each side of the punctuation. If both can stand alone, use a semicolon, a period, or a comma plus a coordinating conjunction.

Question 17 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The introductory modifier "Built from strips of cedar bark and dyed fiber" must immediately modify the thing that was built, the basket.

Trick: After an introductory modifier, check that the next noun is the thing actually described by that modifier.

Question 18 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The pronoun must replace the plural noun "sensors." "Those" is the correct plural comparison pronoun.

Trick: In comparisons, match pronoun number to the noun being replaced. Use "those" for plural count nouns.

Question 19 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The three coordinated verbs must be parallel: sampled, measured, and recorded.

Trick: In a series, make each item follow the same grammatical form.

Question 20 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The packing happened before another past event, the second expedition reaching the valley. Past perfect, "had packed," expresses the earlier past action.

Trick: When two past events are compared, use past perfect for the one completed first when the sequence needs clarification.

Question 21 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Transitions | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The second sentence contrasts with the earlier interpretation, so "However" is the logical transition.

Trick: Identify the relationship between the sentences first. Then choose the transition that names that relationship exactly.

Question 22 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Transitions | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The second population shows an opposing outcome, so "By contrast" is correct.

Trick: Identify the relationship between the sentences first. Then choose the transition that names that relationship exactly.

Question 23 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication, or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

Question 24 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication, or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

Question 25 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication, or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

Question 26 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication, or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

Question 27 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication, or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

MODULE 1: MATH

Question 28 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Linear Equations in One & Two Variables | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Subtract 11 from both sides to get $3x = 21$. Divide by 3, giving $x = 7$.

Trick: Undo addition or subtraction first, then undo multiplication. Check by substitution.

Question 29 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Percentages | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Convert 35% to 0.35 and multiply by 240: $240(0.35) = 84$.

Trick: Percent means per 100. Convert to a decimal or fraction before multiplying.

Question 30 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Ratios, Rates & Proportions | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: There are 8 ratio parts. Each part represents 6 objects, so the first group has $3(6) = 18$.

Trick: Add ratio parts first. Divide the total by the number of parts, then multiply by the desired part count.

Question 31 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Function Notation & Evaluation | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Substitute $x = 5$: $f(5) = 4(5) + 7 = 27$.

Trick: Function notation is substitution. Replace every x with the given input before simplifying.

Question 32 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Coordinate Geometry | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Slope = $(y_2 - y_1)/(x_2 - x_1) = (12 - 4)/(6 - 2) = 2$.

Trick: Keep the subtraction order consistent in numerator and denominator.

Question 33 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Systems of Linear Equations | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Add the equations to eliminate y : $3x = 12$, so $x = 4$. Substitute to get $y = 3$.

Trick: Look for a variable that cancels immediately when equations are added or subtracted.

Question 34 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Equivalent Expressions & Algebraic Manipulation | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Multiply coefficients: $4(5) = 20$. For the same base x , add exponents: $3+4=7$.

Trick: When multiplying powers with the same base, add exponents. Do not multiply the exponents.

Question 35 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Statistics: Mean & Median | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: A mean of 13 for 5 numbers gives a total of 65. The four known numbers total 50, so the fifth is $65 - 50 = 15$.

Trick: Convert a mean problem into a total first: mean times number of values equals total.

Question 36 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Area & Perimeter | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Let width be w . Then length is $3w$. Perimeter = $2(w + 3w) = 8w = 56$, so $w = 7$.

Trick: Translate the relationship before using the perimeter formula.

Question 37 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Probability - Basic | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Probability = favorable outcomes / total outcomes = $7/25$.

Trick: Use the total number of equally likely outcomes in the denominator.

Question 38 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Exponential Functions - Growth & Decay | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Exponential growth multiplies by 1.2 once per year: $200(1.2)^3 = 345.6$.

Trick: Repeated percent change is multiplicative, not additive.

Question 39 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Quadratic Equations - Solving | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Factor the quadratic as $(x - 3)(x - 7) = 0$. Thus $x = 3$ or $x = 7$.

Trick: For a monic quadratic, look for two numbers that multiply to c and add to the coefficient of x .

Question 40 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Circle Equations | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: In standard form, $(x - h)^2 + (y - k)^2 = r^2$. Here $r^2 = 25$, so $r = 5$.

Trick: The constant on the right is radius squared, not radius.

Question 41 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Unit Conversion & Dimensional Analysis | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: 48 meters $\times$ 100 centimeters per meter = 4800 centimeters.

Trick: Write units as conversion factors so unwanted units cancel.

Question 42 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Linear Inequalities | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Subtract 5: $3x < 24$. Divide by positive 3; the inequality direction stays the same, giving $x < 8$.

Trick: Only reverse the inequality sign when multiplying or dividing by a negative number.

Question 43 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Similar Triangles | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The scale factor is $(12)/4 = 3$. Multiply the corresponding side 10 by 3 to get 30.

Trick: Find one known pair of corresponding sides first to get the scale factor.

Question 44 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Interpreting Coefficients in Linear Models | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: The coefficient 6 is the slope, so it gives the predicted change in y for a 1-unit increase in x .

Trick: In $y = mx + b$, m is rate of change and b is the predicted value when $x = 0$.

Question 45 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Polynomial Operations | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Combine like terms: $(2+4)x + (3-5) = 6x - 2$.

Trick: Only combine terms with the same variable part.

Question 46 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Volume & Surface Area | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Volume = $\pi r^2 h = \pi(3)^2(8) = 72\pi$.

Trick: For cylinder volume, square the radius before multiplying by height.

Question 47 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Statistical Inference & Sampling | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Because participation is voluntary and restricted to a self-selected group connected to the topic being studied, the sample may differ systematically from the overall student population. This creates selection bias and limits generalization.

Trick: Ask whether the sampling method gives the target population a fair chance to be represented.

Question 48 | Correct Answer: 78

Skill: Equivalent Expressions & Algebraic Manipulation | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: $10x + 18 = 2(5x + 9) = 2(39) = 78$.

Trick: Look for a direct multiple of the given expression instead of solving for x unnecessarily.

Question 49 | Correct Answer: 2

Skill: Systems of Linear Equations | Difficulty: Medium

Explanation: Let s be boxes of 6 and b boxes of 11. Then $s+b=5$ and $6s+11b=45$. Substitution gives $s=2$.

Trick: When there are two quantities and two totals, write one equation for number of groups and one for total amount.

MODULE 2 EASIER: READING & WRITING**Question 50 | Correct Answer: D**

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: In context, "extol" means praise highly. The surrounding sentence requires that sense; the other choices conflict with the relationship described.

Trick: Replace the tested word with each option. Keep the choice that preserves both the sentence logic and the exact degree of meaning.

Question 51 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: In context, "spurious" means false or not genuine. The surrounding sentence requires that sense; the other choices conflict with the relationship described.

Trick: Replace the tested word with each option. Keep the choice that preserves both the sentence logic and the exact degree of meaning.

Question 52 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: In context, "repertory" means stock of works or skills available for performance. The surrounding sentence requires that sense; the other choices conflict with the relationship described.

Trick: Replace the tested word with each option. Keep the choice that preserves both the sentence logic and the exact degree of meaning.

Question 53 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: In context, "counterintuitive" means contrary to what one would expect. The surrounding sentence requires that sense; the other choices conflict with the relationship described.

Trick: Replace the tested word with each option. Keep the choice that preserves both the sentence logic and the exact degree of meaning.

Question 54 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Main Idea | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The passage centers on the evidence that the named feature is associated with the outcome and may have been underestimated, while carefully avoiding a stronger causal claim than the study supports.

Trick: Choose the answer that covers the whole passage and matches its level of certainty. Reject choices with words such as "only," "proves," or claims that reverse the relationship.

Question 55 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Main Purpose | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The passage first identifies a limitation, then explains how a newer approach addresses that limitation without making an absolute rejection of the older method.

Trick: Track what each sentence is doing. A purpose answer must describe the passage as a whole, not just one detail.

Question 56 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Overall Structure | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The correct choice follows the sequence of moves in the passage: accepted view, complicating evidence, mechanism, and a qualified conclusion.

Trick: For structure questions, summarize each sentence in a few words before comparing the answer choices.

Question 57 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Detail (According to the Text) | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The passage explicitly states that the difference between the groups was smallest on the final observation. The other choices alter the sample counts, experimental design, or direction of the result.

Trick: For detail questions, locate the exact sentence that answers the question. Do not infer beyond what the passage directly says.

Question 58 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Inference / Complete the Text | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The follow-up pattern strengthens the possibility of a relationship because changes in the two variables move together over time. However, untested background factors remain possible, so the evidence does not justify an absolute causal claim.

Trick: Look for the answer that uses all parts of the evidence. Hard inference questions often reward a conclusion that is stronger than mere correlation but weaker than proof.

Question 59 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Inference / Complete the Text | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The follow-up pattern strengthens the possibility of a relationship because changes in the two variables move together over time. However, untested background factors remain possible, so the evidence does not justify an absolute causal claim.

Trick: Look for the answer that uses all parts of the evidence. Hard inference questions often reward a conclusion that is stronger than mere correlation but weaker than proof.

Question 60 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Evidence - Data / Graph / Table | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The correct choice accurately describes the table and matches the claim. In the harder version, a small local reversal does not erase the overall positive tendency because the model does not require perfect monotonicity.

Trick: Read the claim before the numbers. Then choose the option that is both numerically accurate and logically relevant to that exact claim.

Question 61 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Evidence - Support / Weaken | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: If controlling another factor removes the outcome difference while the proposed explanatory factor remains different, the original explanation is weakened by a plausible confound.

Trick: For support or weaken questions, ask what evidence changes the causal logic, not merely what mentions the same topic.

Question 62 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Cross-Text | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Text 2 does not simply reject Text 1. It accepts part of the relationship while limiting the conditions under which the indicator can be relied on.

Trick: Cross-text questions often hinge on degree. Distinguish disagreement from qualification and partial agreement.

Question 63 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Function (Underlined Portion) | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The underlined sentence provides the logical bridge between the observed pattern and the methodological or causal conclusion that follows.

Trick: Ask why the author needed that exact sentence. Focus on its role in the argument, not merely its topic.

Question 64 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Quotation Illustrates Claim | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The correct quotation directly expresses every part of the stated characterization. The distractors either support only part of the claim, contradict it, or merely describe the setting.

Trick: Match every part of the claim. A quotation that supports only half of a two-part or qualified characterization is not enough.

Question 65 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The clause after the blank explains the "surprising result." A colon correctly introduces that explanation after a complete clause.

Trick: A colon can follow a complete sentence to introduce an explanation, example, or list.

Question 66 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The plural subject "murals" requires the plural verb "depict."

Trick: Locate the head noun of the subject before choosing the verb.

Question 67 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The comma is followed by a participial phrase describing the result of the preceding clause. "Allowing" correctly creates that modifying phrase.

Trick: After a complete clause plus comma, an -ing participial phrase can show a result without creating a comma splice.

Question 68 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: With "neither...nor," the verb generally agrees with the nearer subject. The nearer subject "report" is singular, so "provides" is correct.

Trick: For neither/nor and either/or, check the noun closest to the verb.

Question 69 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The research belongs to two sisters. The plural possessive of "sisters" is formed by adding an apostrophe after the final s.

Trick: First decide whether the owner is singular or plural, then form the possessive.

Question 70 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Transitions | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The sentences describe a sequence of steps, so "Then" is correct.

Trick: Identify the relationship between the sentences first. Then choose the transition that names that relationship exactly.

Question 71 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Transitions | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The second sentence acknowledges a limitation but gives a reason the result still matters, so "Nevertheless" fits.

Trick: Identify the relationship between the sentences first. Then choose the transition that names that relationship exactly.

Question 72 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication, or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

Question 73 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication,

or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

Question 74 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication, or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

Question 75 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication, or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

Question 76 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The correct response selects the specific notes needed for the stated writing goal and connects them with an accurate logical relationship. The other choices contain relevant facts but omit the comparison, qualification, implication, or recommendation required by the goal.

Trick: Read the writing goal first. Then identify which notes must be connected to perform that exact rhetorical task, rather than choosing a sentence merely because every fact in it is true.

MODULE 2 EASIER: MATH

Question 77 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Linear Equations in One & Two Variables | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Subtract 19 from both sides to get $3x = 33$. Divide by 3, giving $x = 11$.

Trick: Undo addition or subtraction first, then undo multiplication. Check by substitution.

Question 78 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Percentages | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Convert 35% to 0.35 and multiply by 320: $320(0.35) = 112$.

Trick: Percent means per 100. Convert to a decimal or fraction before multiplying.

Question 79 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Ratios, Rates & Proportions | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: There are 8 ratio parts. Each part represents 8 objects, so the first group has $3(8) = 24$.

Trick: Add ratio parts first. Divide the total by the number of parts, then multiply by the desired part count.

Question 80 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Function Notation & Evaluation | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Substitute $x = 5$: $f(5) = 4(5) + 11 = 31$.

Trick: Function notation is substitution. Replace every x with the given input before simplifying.

Question 81 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Coordinate Geometry | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Slope = $(y_2 - y_1)/(x_2 - x_1) = (20 - 8)/(6 - 2) = 3$.

Trick: Keep the subtraction order consistent in numerator and denominator.

Question 82 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Systems of Linear Equations | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Add the equations to eliminate y: $3x = 12$, so $x = 4$. Substitute to get $y = 5$.

Trick: Look for a variable that cancels immediately when equations are added or subtracted.

Question 83 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Equivalent Expressions & Algebraic Manipulation | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Multiply coefficients: $4(5) = 20$. For the same base x, add exponents: $3+6=9$.

Trick: When multiplying powers with the same base, add exponents. Do not multiply the exponents.

Question 84 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Statistics: Mean & Median | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: A mean of 15 for 5 numbers gives a total of 75. The four known numbers total 50, so the fifth is $75 - 50 = 25$.

Trick: Convert a mean problem into a total first: mean times number of values equals total.

Question 85 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Area & Perimeter | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Let width be w. Then length is 3w. Perimeter = $2(w + 3w) = 8w = 88$, so $w = 11$.

Trick: Translate the relationship before using the perimeter formula.

Question 86 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Probability - Basic | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Probability = favorable outcomes / total outcomes = $7/45$.

Trick: Use the total number of equally likely outcomes in the denominator.

Question 87 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Exponential Functions - Growth & Decay | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Exponential growth multiplies by 1.1 once per year: $200(1.1)^3 = 266.2$.

Trick: Repeated percent change is multiplicative, not additive.

Question 88 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Quadratic Equations - Solving | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Factor the quadratic as $(x - 3)(x - 9) = 0$. Thus $x = 3$ or $x = 9$.

Trick: For a monic quadratic, look for two numbers that multiply to c and add to the coefficient of x.

Question 89 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Circle Equations | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: In standard form, $(x - h)^2 + (y - k)^2 = r^2$. Here $r^2 = 25$, so $r = 5$.

Trick: The constant on the right is radius squared, not radius.

Question 90 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Unit Conversion & Dimensional Analysis | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: 60 meters x 100 centimeters per meter = 6000 centimeters.

Trick: Write units as conversion factors so unwanted units cancel.

Question 91 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Linear Inequalities | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Subtract 5: $3x < 36$. Divide by positive 3; the inequality direction stays the same, giving $x < 12$.

Trick: Only reverse the inequality sign when multiplying or dividing by a negative number.

Question 92 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Similar Triangles | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The scale factor is $(12)/6 = 2$. Multiply the corresponding side 14 by 2 to get 28.

Trick: Find one known pair of corresponding sides first to get the scale factor.

Question 93 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Interpreting Coefficients in Linear Models | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: The coefficient 6 is the slope, so it gives the predicted change in y for a 1-unit increase in x.

Trick: In $y = mx + b$, m is rate of change and b is the predicted value when $x = 0$.

Question 94 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Polynomial Operations | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Combine like terms: $(2+4)x + (3-9) = 6x - 6$.

Trick: Only combine terms with the same variable part.

Question 95 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Volume & Surface Area | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Volume = $\pi r^2 h = \pi(3)^2(12) = 108\pi$.

Trick: For cylinder volume, square the radius before multiplying by height.

Question 96 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Statistical Inference & Sampling | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Because participation is voluntary and restricted to a self-selected group connected to the topic being studied, the sample may differ systematically from the overall student population. This creates selection bias and limits generalization.

Trick: Ask whether the sampling method gives the target population a fair chance to be represented.

Question 97 | Correct Answer: 118

Skill: Equivalent Expressions & Algebraic Manipulation | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: $10x + 18 = 2(5x + 9) = 2(59) = 118$.

Trick: Look for a direct multiple of the given expression instead of solving for x unnecessarily.

Question 98 | Correct Answer: 3

Skill: Systems of Linear Equations | Difficulty: Easy

Explanation: Let s be boxes of 6 and b boxes of 11. Then $s+b=7$ and $6s+11b=62$. Substitution gives $s=3$.

Trick: When there are two quantities and two totals, write one equation for number of groups and one for total amount.

MODULE 2 HARDER: READING & WRITING

Question 99 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: In context, "latitude" means freedom to act or make choices. The surrounding sentence narrows the meaning by contrasting the intended interpretation with plausible alternatives.

Trick: Do not choose a dictionary meaning merely because it is possible. Substitute each option and keep the one that preserves the exact logical relationship in context.

Question 100 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: In context, "oblique" means indirect rather than openly stated. The surrounding sentence narrows the meaning by contrasting the intended interpretation with plausible alternatives.

Trick: Do not choose a dictionary meaning merely because it is possible. Substitute each option and keep the one that preserves the exact logical relationship in context.

Question 101 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: In context, "repertory" means stock of methods or works available for use. The surrounding sentence narrows the meaning by contrasting the intended interpretation with plausible alternatives.

Trick: Do not choose a dictionary meaning merely because it is possible. Substitute each option and keep the one that preserves the exact logical relationship in context.

Question 102 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Words in Context | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: In context, "equivocal" means open to more than one interpretation. The surrounding sentence narrows the meaning by contrasting the intended interpretation with plausible alternatives.

Trick: Do not choose a dictionary meaning merely because it is possible. Substitute each option and keep the one that preserves the exact logical relationship in context.

Question 103 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Main Idea | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The passage first presents a proxy, then a mechanism that distorts it, and finally a qualified defense of the proxy after that mechanism is modeled. The correct answer preserves all three parts.

Trick: For dense main-idea questions, track the author's final position. Beware choices that keep the problem but omit the qualification or overstate the conclusion.

Question 104 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Main Purpose | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The passage does not reject the proxy. It identifies a specific confound and presents selective direct measurement as a calibration strategy.

Trick: Purpose answers should describe what the passage does, not merely name its topic. Preserve whether the author rejects, qualifies, or refines a method.

Question 105 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Overall Structure | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The key sequence is support, apparent exception, mechanism, then qualified retention. Only the correct choice captures all four stages.

Trick: Structure questions reward sequence. Reduce each paragraph or sentence group to a function before comparing answer choices.

Question 106 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Detail (According to the Text) | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The passage explicitly states that the matched-site analysis produced the same pattern. It also explicitly denies random assignment and allows for unmeasured differences.

Trick: On detail questions, answer only what the text states. Distractors often turn a caveat into a guarantee.

Question 107 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Inference / Complete the Text | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The observed ceiling-like pattern fits the model, but the unmeasured limiting resource prevents a definitive causal conclusion.

Trick: Choose the conclusion whose strength matches the evidence. "Consistent with" is often safer than "proves" when a proposed mechanism was not directly measured.

Question 108 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Inference / Complete the Text | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Persistence of the association after restriction weakens one confounding account, but it does not establish causation. The smaller effect also suggests the third variable may have explained part of the original association.

Trick: Inference questions often hinge on "weakened, not eliminated." Avoid all-or-nothing conclusions from partial controls.

Question 109 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Evidence - Data / Graph / Table | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Both series rise overall, but Group A rises much more from the common starting point to the final point. That is exactly the predicted interaction pattern.

Trick: For multi-line graphs, compare both direction and magnitude of change. A shared starting value does not imply identical responses.

Question 110 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Evidence - Data / Graph / Table | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The isolated point departs sharply from the relationship followed by the other observations, making it the strongest evidence that another factor may be affecting that case.

Trick: When a claim mentions an additional variable, look for an outlier or subgroup pattern that the main trend alone does not explain.

Question 111 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Evidence - Support / Weaken | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Random manipulation plus a control group most directly addresses causality. The other findings concern replication, measurement, or imperfect correlation rather than direct causal influence.

Trick: To support a causal claim, prefer randomized manipulation over another observational correlation.

Question 112 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Evidence - Support / Weaken | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: If the outcome difference vanishes after matching on another factor while the proposed explanatory difference remains, the other factor is a strong alternative explanation.

Trick: To weaken "X explains Y," look for a case where X remains different but Y no longer differs after another variable is controlled.

Question 113 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Cross-Text | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Text 2 accepts the within-region relationship but rejects a universal pooled calibration. The response is therefore a qualification, not a total rejection.

Trick: In cross-text questions, separate agreement about the phenomenon from disagreement about scope, method, or interpretation.

Question 114 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Function (Underlined Portion) | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The sentence does not merely mention exceptions. It shows that they cluster under the exact condition the proposed mechanism predicts.

Trick: Ask why the author included that sentence at that point. Here, its location and pattern provide support for the following mechanism.

Question 115 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Quotation Illustrates Claim | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The correct quotation explicitly contains both sides of the qualified response. The distractors show only one attitude or an unrelated reaction.

Trick: When a claim contains "mixed with," "tempered by," or another qualification, the best quotation must demonstrate both components.

Question 116 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: With neither...nor, the verb agrees with the nearer subject, "outlier," which is singular, so "is" is correct.

Trick: With neither/nor, check the noun closest to the verb.

Question 117 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Both sides are independent clauses. A semicolon correctly joins them; "however" is set off within the second clause.

Trick: Before choosing punctuation, test whether both sides can stand as complete sentences.

Question 118 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The introductory phrase “Based on measurements...” must logically modify the noun that follows. The pattern is based on the measurements.

Trick: After an introductory modifier, the next noun must be the thing described by that modifier.

Question 119 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The subject of the second clause is the gerund phrase “determining which annotations are contemporaneous...,” which is singular, so “requires” is correct.

Trick: Long subjects can hide their number. Find the head of the subject before matching the verb.

Question 120 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Grammar / Conventions | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The identification occurred before another past event, the laboratory’s adoption of the protocol, so past perfect is appropriate.

Trick: Use past perfect for the earlier of two clearly ordered past events when the sequence matters.

Question 121 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Transitions | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The second sentence describes the action taken for the purpose stated in the first sentence, so “To this end” is the most precise transition.

Trick: Determine the logical relationship between the sentences before considering how familiar a transition sounds.

Question 122 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Transitions | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The second sentence complicates the impression created by the pooled relationship, so a contrast transition is required.

Trick: Determine the logical relationship between the sentences before considering how familiar a transition sounds.

Question 123 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The correct choice combines the relevant evidence with the exact level of caution required by the student’s goal. The distractors either omit the limitation or merely repeat isolated notes.

Trick: Rhetorical synthesis is goal driven. Include only the facts needed to satisfy the stated purpose, and match the strength of the claim to the evidence.

Question 124 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The correct choice combines the relevant evidence with the exact level of caution required by the student’s goal. The distractors either omit the limitation or merely repeat isolated notes.

Trick: Rhetorical synthesis is goal driven. Include only the facts needed to satisfy the stated purpose, and match the strength of the claim to the evidence.

Question 125 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Rhetorical Synthesis | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The correct choice combines the relevant evidence with the exact level of caution required by the student’s goal. The distractors either omit the limitation or merely repeat isolated notes.

Trick: Rhetorical synthesis is goal driven. Include only the facts needed to satisfy the stated purpose, and match the strength of the claim to the evidence.

MODULE 2 HARDER: MATH**Question 126 | Correct Answer: C**

Skill: Linear & Exponential Models from Data | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Solve $u = (x - 40)/5$ for x : $x = 5u + 40$. Then $y = 6(5u + 40) - 17 = 30u + 223$. Since $v = 2y + 9$, $v = 60u + 455$.

Trick: For transformed regression variables, solve each new-variable definition for the original variable and substitute in stages. Do not shift or scale the intercept by intuition.

Question 127 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Volume & Surface Area | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The volume ratio is $(5/3)^3$, so the linear scale factor is $5/3$. Surface area scales by the square, giving $270(5/3)^2 = 750$.

Trick: Convert a volume ratio to a linear ratio by taking the cube root before using the square for surface area.

Question 128 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Factoring Polynomials | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The product is $x^4 + (2(13) - a^2)x^2 + 169$. Thus $26 - a^2 = -10$, so $a^2 = 36$ and $a = 6$. Therefore $a + 13 = 19$.

Trick: Recognize conjugate-like factors. The x^3 and x terms cancel, so compare only the x^2 coefficient and constant.

Question 129 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Circle Equations | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The radius CP has slope $8/6$, so the tangent slope is $-6/8$. Using point-slope form through P and $x = 10$ gives $y = 7/2$.

Trick: For a tangent, first find the radius slope, take the negative reciprocal, then use the tangent point in point-slope form.

Question 130 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Circles: Arc Length & Sector Area | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The angle between two tangents equals 180 degrees minus the minor arc, so the minor arc is $180 - 46 = 134$. The major arc is 226 , and the inscribed angle intercepting it is half: 113 degrees.

Trick: Track which arc is intercepted. A vertex on the minor arc forces the inscribed angle to intercept the major arc.

Question 131 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Percentages | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Let the original price be P . Then $P(112/100)(85/100) = 476.00$. Dividing by both multipliers gives $P = 500$.

Trick: For reverse percent changes, divide by the successive multipliers in reverse or solve one product equation. Do not subtract the percentages.

Question 132 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Absolute Value Equations | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Solve both cases: $3x - 8 = 2x + 7$, giving $x = 15$; and $-(3x - 8) = 2x + 7$, giving $x = 1/5$. Both make the right side nonnegative, so the sum is $76/5$.

Trick: For $|A| = B$, solve $A = B$ and $A = -B$, then verify B is nonnegative at each candidate.

Question 133 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Radical and Rational Exponents | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Squaring gives $x^2 - 8x + 6 = 0$. Solve the quadratic, then check candidates in the original equation because squaring can create an extraneous root. Only $x = 4 + \sqrt{10}$ satisfies the original equation.

Trick: After squaring a radical equation, always substitute every candidate back into the unsquared equation.

Question 134 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Nonlinear Systems of Equations | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Set the equations equal: $x^2 - 8x + (10 - k) = 0$. Exactly one intersection means discriminant 0 , so $(8)^2 - 4(10 - k) = 0$. Solving gives $k = -6$.

Trick: One intersection between a line and parabola means the resulting quadratic has discriminant zero.

Question 135 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Discriminant & Number of Solutions | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Exactly one real solution requires discriminant 0. After dividing by 4: $(k - 5)^2 - (k + 2)(k - 8) = 0$. The k^2 terms cancel, leaving $-4k + 41 = 0$, so $k = 41/4$.

Trick: Write the discriminant before expanding. When k appears in every coefficient, high-degree terms often cancel.

Question 136 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Quadratic Functions - Graphs & Properties | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: At the vertex $x = 4$, the parabola equals the tangent horizontal line $y = 5$. Thus $5 = 4^2 - 8(4) + c = -16 + c$, so $c = 21$.

Trick: A horizontal line tangent to a parabola touches it at the vertex. Use the vertex x -coordinate and y -value together.

Question 137 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Similar Triangles | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The larger area is $54 + 96 = 150$. The area ratio is $(5/3)^2$, so the linear scale factor is $5/3$. Multiply 9 by that factor to get 15.

Trick: Area ratios are squares of side ratios. Recover the larger area first, then take the square root of the area scale factor.

Question 138 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Exponential Functions - Growth & Decay | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: From $x = 2$ to $x = 5$, the output is multiplied by $27 = 3^3$, so the per-unit factor is 3. Moving backward 2 units from $x = 2$ divides by 3^2 : $f(0) = 18/9 = 2$.

Trick: Use equal x -steps to identify the multiplicative factor. To move left on an exponential graph, divide by the factor.

Question 139 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Function Notation & Evaluation | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Because $f(g(k)) = 3g(k) - 2 = 55$, $g(k) = 19$. Then $2k + 5 = 19$, so $k = 7$. Therefore $g(k) + k = 26$.

Trick: Work backward through the outer function first, then solve the inner function. Do not expand everything at once unless necessary.

Question 140 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Rational Expressions & Equations | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Multiply by $x - 3$: $x + 7 = 15 + 2(x - 3)$. Solving gives $x = -2$, which is allowed because it is not 3.

Trick: Clear denominators only after recording excluded values. Then check that the solution does not make an original denominator zero.

Question 141 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Statistical Inference & Sampling | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Random assignment addresses treatment comparison and supports causal inference for the study sample. It does not make a restricted or self-selected sample representative of a broader population.

Trick: Separate two questions: causation depends mainly on assignment; generalization depends mainly on sampling.

Question 142 | Correct Answer: A

Skill: Standard Deviation | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Adding or subtracting constants does not change standard deviation. Multiplying by -3 multiplies standard deviation by 3, then dividing by 2 divides it by 2. Thus $SD(C) = 6 \times 3 / 2 = 9$.

Trick: Track only multiplicative scale factors for standard deviation. Ignore shifts.

Question 143 | Correct Answer: D

Skill: Conditional Probability & Two-Way Tables | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: There are 120 club participants and 180 nonparticipants. Passers are 90 from the club and 60 from outside, for 150 total passers. The required conditional probability is $90/150 = 3/5$.

Trick: Once the condition "known to have passed" appears, rebuild the denominator using only students who passed.

Question 144 | Correct Answer: C

Skill: Quadratic Functions - Graphs & Properties | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: Use the factored form $y = a(x - 2)(x - 10)$. At the vertex $x = 6$, the product is $(4)(-4) = -16$. Set $32 = a(-16)$, giving $a = -2$.

Trick: When x-intercepts are given, use factored form. Substitute one additional point to determine the vertical scale factor.

Question 145 | Correct Answer: B

Skill: Systems of Equations - Number of Solutions | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: For no solution, the x and y coefficients must be proportional while the constants are not. The y coefficient is multiplied by 3, so k must equal $3(4) = 12$. The second constant is not $3(11)$, so the lines are distinct and parallel.

Trick: No solution means proportional variable coefficients but a nonproportional constant.

Question 146 | Correct Answer: -6

Skill: Polynomial Operations | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: For a monic polynomial, the x^3 coefficient is the negative sum of the four roots counted with multiplicity: $a = -(2(2) + 5 + (-3)) = -6$.

Trick: Count repeated roots according to multiplicity before applying Vieta's formula.

Question 147 | Correct Answer: 1

Skill: Volume & Surface Area | Difficulty: Hard

Explanation: The displaced volume equals the sphere's volume. If the water rises h, then $\pi(6)^2h = (4/3)\pi(3)^3$. Cancel π and solve to get $h = 1$.

Trick: For displacement in a cylindrical tank, equate displaced volume to base area times rise. The factor π often cancels.